

10 e5 Nd7

Black has an important alternative in 10... dxe5. This leads to a very messy endgame after 11 dxe5 Qxd1 12 Rxd1 Nd7. If White now plays 13 cxb5 then Black takes on e5. Therefore White must sacrifice a pawn with 13 e6 and after 13... fxe6 14 cxb5 axb5 15 Bf4 b4 16 Na4 Nb6 17 Nxb6 Rxb6 the position is difficult to assess.

11 e6

The main line is 11 cxb5 and that is considered in the next game

11... fxe6 12 d5 exd5 13 cxd5

This position is generally quoted as unclear as, in return for the pawn he has sacrificed, White has some nice squares for his pieces.

13... Na7

Twenty years ago, in the battle of the doctors, Dr Nunn lost this position with Black against Dr Hubner. In that game he played 13 ...Na5. He obviously did not let the intervening years go to waste.

14 Nd4 Nf6 15 Re1 b4 16 Nce2 c5! 17 dxc6 e5 18 Nb3 d5 (Diagram 18)

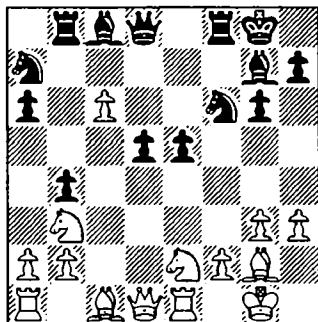


Diagram 18

Black has taken over the centre

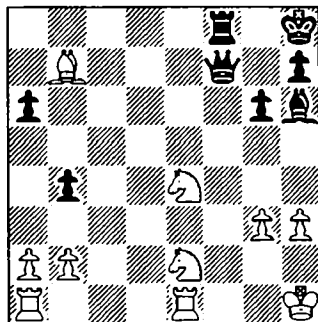


Diagram 19

A very deep resignation!

Black's enterprising play has earned him a big centre and he now threatens to re-establish his material advantage with 19... Nxc6. White could try 19 c7 but after 19... Qxc7 20 Bxd5+ Nxd5 21 Qxd5+ Kh8 there are glaring holes on the light squares around his king 19 Bg5 Nxc6 20 Bxf6 Qxf6 21 Qxd5+ Kh8!?

21... Rf7 would have prevented 22 Qxc6, but Black encourages it.

22 Qxc6 Qxf2+ 23 Kh1 Bb7 24 Qxb7 Rxb7 25 Bxb7 e4 26 Nd2 Bh6 27 Nxe4 Qf7 (Diagram 19) White resigns

Perhaps White was just demonstrating that he too had seen the variation 28 Bc6 Qc4 29 Bb7 Qb5 30 Nd6 Qd7! when Black threatens not only the knight on d6 but also a decisive check on h3.

Game 46

□ Arkell ■ Buckley

South Wales Masters 2001

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nf3 Bg7 4 g3 0-0 5 Bg2 d6 6 0-0 Nc6 7 Nc3 a6 8 h3 Rb8 9 e4 b5 10 e5 Nd7 11 cxb5 axb5 12 Ng5!

White now has two threats. The first is to take the bishop on c6 and the other is to play 13 e6. Black has no choice but to sacrifice a piece for White's centre pawns. There are several ways to do this.

12...dxe5

The position after 12...Nxd4 13 Qxd4 Nxe5 14 Qh4 h6 has occurred in numerous games between the two stalwarts of the weekend tournament circuit, Keith Arkell and Mark Hebden. Black has only two pawns for the piece but if he can get his centre rolling White may find that he has very few good squares on which to put all his pieces. Still, the current view seems to be that after 15 Nf3 Nxf3 16 Bxf3 e6 17 Qxd8 Rxd8 18 a4! White has the better chances in the endgame.

13 Bxc6 exd4 14 Nxb5

14 Ne2 h6 15 Nf3 e5 would be an example of the black centre rolling. White should steer clear of this.

14...Rb6 (Diagram 20)

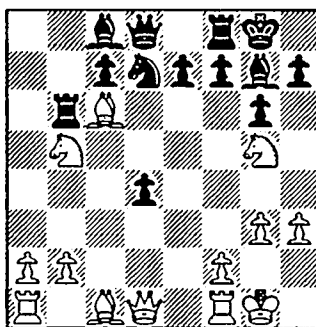


Diagram 20
A critical position

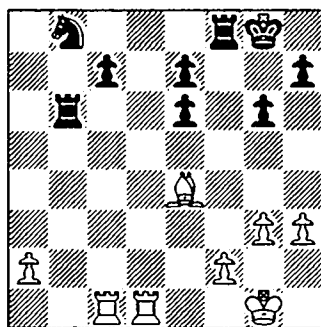


Diagram 21
The endgame is good for White

White is a piece for a pawn up but in a bit of a tangle. If the bishop retreats Black just takes the knight so let's have a look at his other attempts to save the piece.

1) He can protect the bishop with his queen. 15 Qf3 obviously won't do because of 15...Ne5, while 15 Qc2 also fails to do the job on account of 15...d3! 16 Qc4? (16 Qxd3 limits the damage) 16...Ne5 17 Qh4 and Black calmly stops the mate threat with 17...h6.

2) White can exchange his bishop for the black knight. That certainly